

Mac Terminal Cheat Sheet

Useful commands for your Thuldai website & everyday Mac work · August 2026

Navigate & folders

Command	What it does	Example
<code>pwd</code>	Print working directory — where you are now	<code>pwd</code>
<code>cd PATH</code>	Change directory — go into a folder	<code>cd ~/Projects/NEPAL-AUSTRALIA/website</code>
<code>cd ..</code>	Go up one folder	<code>cd ..</code>
<code>cd ~</code>	Go to your home folder	<code>cd ~</code>
<code>ls</code>	List files in current folder	<code>ls</code>
<code>ls -la</code>	List all files with details (size, dates, hidden)	<code>ls -la</code>
<code>mkdir NAME</code>	Make directory — create folder	<code>mkdir assets</code>
<code>cp A B</code>	Copy file or folder	<code>cp index.html backup.html</code>
<code>mv A B</code>	Move or rename	<code>mv old.html new.html</code>
<code>rm FILE</code>	Remove file (no Trash — be careful)	<code>rm temp.txt</code>
<code>open .</code>	Open current folder in Finder	<code>open .</code>
<code>open FILE</code>	Open file with default app	<code>open index.html</code>

`~` = home folder · `..` = parent folder · `./file` = file in current folder

Read & search files

Command	What it does	Example
<code>cat FILE</code>	Print whole file	<code>cat readme.txt</code>
<code>head -n 20 FILE</code>	First 20 lines	<code>head -n 20 index.html</code>
<code>tail -n 20 FILE</code>	Last 20 lines	<code>tail -n 20 server.log</code>
<code>less FILE</code>	Scroll through file (q to quit)	<code>less style.css</code>
<code>grep "text" FILE</code>	Search for text in a file	<code>grep "Thuldai" index.html</code>
<code>grep -r "text" .</code>	Search in all files under current folder	<code>grep -r "localhost" .</code>
<code>find . -name "*.html"</code>	Find files by name	<code>find . -name "*.html"</code>

Local website (preview your site)

Command	What it does	Example
<code>python3 -m http.server PORT</code>	Start a simple web server in current folder	<code>python3 -m http.server 8081</code>
<code>curl URL</code>	Test a URL from Terminal	<code>curl http://localhost:8081/index.html</code>
<code>curl -I URL</code>	Show headers only (check if server responds)	<code>curl -I http://localhost:8081/</code>

Same Mac: `http://localhost:8081/index.html` · Phone (same Wi-Fi): `http://YOUR_IP:8081/index.html`

Network & IP

Command	What it does	Example
<code>ipconfig getifaddr en0</code>	Your Mac's Wi-Fi IP (for phone testing)	<code>ipconfig getifaddr en0</code>
<code>ifconfig</code>	All network interfaces & IPs	<code>ifconfig grep "inet "</code>
<code>ping HOST</code>	Test if something is reachable	<code>ping google.com</code>
<code>ping -c 4 HOST</code>	Ping 4 times then stop	<code>ping -c 4 192.168.1.1</code>

`en0` = usually Wi-Fi · `en1` = sometimes Ethernet

Ports & processes

Command	What it does	Example
<code>lsof -nP -iTCP:8081 -sTCP:LISTEN</code>	Is anything listening on port 8081?	<code>lsof -nP -iTCP:8081 -sTCP:LISTEN</code>
<code>kill PID</code>	Stop a process by ID	<code>kill 12345</code>
<code>kill -9 PID</code>	Force stop a process	<code>kill -9 12345</code>
<code>ps aux grep python</code>	Find Python processes	<code>ps aux grep python</code>

Permissions & scripts

Command	What it does	Example
<code>chmod +x FILE</code>	Make file executable	<code>chmod +x start-local-server.command</code>
<code>./script.sh</code>	Run a script in current folder	<code>./start-local-server.command</code>

Python

Command	What it does	Example
<code>python3 --version</code>	Check Python version	<code>python3 --version</code>
<code>pip3 install PACKAGE</code>	Install a Python library	<code>pip3 install pymupdf</code>
<code>python3 script.py</code>	Run a Python file	<code>python3 build_complete_book.py</code>

Git (save & share code)

Command	What it does	Example
<code>git status</code>	What changed?	<code>git status</code>
<code>git add .</code>	Stage all changes	<code>git add .</code>
<code>git commit -m "msg"</code>	Save a snapshot	<code>git commit -m "Update logo"</code>
<code>git push</code>	Upload to remote (GitHub etc.)	<code>git push</code>
<code>git pull</code>	Download latest from remote	<code>git pull</code>
<code>git log --oneline -5</code>	Last 5 commits	<code>git log --oneline -5</code>

Useful syntax symbols

Symbol	Meaning	Example
<code> </code> (pipe)	Send output into another command	<code>ls grep html</code>
<code>></code>	Save output to file (overwrite)	<code>ls > files.txt</code>
<code>>></code>	Append output to file	<code>echo hello >> log.txt</code>
<code>&&</code>	Run 2nd command only if 1st succeeds	<code>cd website && python3 -m http.server 8081</code>
<code>;</code>	Run commands one after another	<code>cd website; ls</code>
<code>#</code>	Comment (ignored)	<code># this is a note</code>
<code>Ctrl+C</code>	Stop running command (e.g. stop server)	while server is running
<code>Ctrl+L</code>	Clear screen	
<code>↑ / ↓</code>	Previous / next command in history	

Paths on Mac

Form	Meaning
<code>/Users/shishirchandrapoudel/...</code>	Full path from root
<code>~/Projects/...</code>	Shortcut to your home folder
<code>./file</code>	File in current directory
<code>../file</code>	File in parent directory

Use quotes for paths with spaces: `cd "/Users/.../NEPAL-AUSTRALIA/website"`

Your daily 5 — Thuldai website

```
cd "/Users/shishirchandrapoudel/Projects/NEPAL-AUSTRALIA/website"  
python3 -m http.server 8081  
lsof -nP -iTCP:8081 -sTCP:LISTEN  
ipconfig getifaddr en0  
open http://localhost:8081/index.html
```